



UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS
International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/11

Paper 1 Reading Passage (Core)

May/June 2012

READING BOOKLET INSERT

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Insert contains the reading passage for use with all questions on the Question Paper.

This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.



Read the following passage carefully and then answer all the questions on the Question Paper.

Gerald (Gerry) Durrell, an author and animal lover, spent part of his childhood in the 1930s on the Greek island of Corfu. In this passage he describes Mr Kralefsky, who was one of his private tutors.

My Tutor Kralefsky

Kralefsky lived in the top two storeys of a square, mildewed, grand old house that stood on the outskirts of the town. I climbed the wide staircase and rapped a sharp tattoo on the knocker that decorated the front door. I waited, glowering to myself and digging the heel of my shoe into the wine-red carpet with considerable violence. Just as I was about to knock again there came the soft pad of footsteps and the front door was flung wide to reveal my new tutor.

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I decided immediately that Kralefsky was not a human being at all, but a gnome who had disguised himself as one by putting on an antiquated but very elegant suit. He had a large, egg-shaped head with flattened sides that were tilted back against a smoothly rounded humpback. This gave him the curious appearance of being permanently in the middle of shrugging his shoulders and peering up into the sky. A long, fine-bridged nose with widely flared nostrils curved out of his face, and his extremely large eyes were liquid and of a pale brown colour. They had a fixed, far-away look in them as though their owner were just waking up out of a trance. His wide, thin mouth managed to combine primness with humour, and now it was stretched across his face in a smile of welcome, showing even but discoloured teeth.

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‘Gerry Durrell?’ he asked bobbing like a courting sparrow, and flapping his large, bony hands at me. ‘Gerry Durrell, is it not? Come in, my dear boy, do come in.’

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‘Through here; this is the room we shall work in,’ fluted Kralefsky, throwing open a door and ushering me into a small, sparsely furnished room. I put my books on the table and sat down in the chair he indicated. He leaned over the table, balancing on the tips of his beautifully manicured fingers, and smiled at me in a vague way. I smiled back, not knowing quite what he expected.

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‘Friends!’ he exclaimed rapturously. ‘It is most *important* that we are friends. I am quite, quite certain we will become friends, aren’t you?’

I nodded seriously, biting the inside of my cheeks to prevent myself from smiling.

‘Friendship,’ he murmured, shutting his eyes in ecstasy at the thought, ‘friendship! That’s the ticket!’

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His lips moved silently, and I wondered if he was praying, and if so whether it was for me, himself, or both of us. A fly circled his head and then settled confidently on his nose. Kralefsky started, brushed it away, opened his eyes, and blinked at me.

‘Yes, yes, that’s it,’ he said firmly. ‘I’m sure we shall be friends. Your mother tells me that you have a great love of natural history. This, you see, gives us something in common straight away ... a bond, as it were, eh? I am by way of being an aviculturist, but only an amateur,’ he volunteered modestly. ‘I thought perhaps you might care to see my collection of birds. Half an hour or so with the feathered creatures will, I venture to think, do us no harm before we start work. Besides, I was a *little* late this morning, and one or two of them need fresh water.’

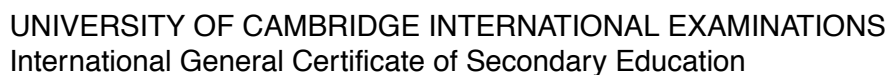
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35

He led the way up a creaking staircase to the top of the house, and paused in front of a green door. He produced an immense bunch of keys that jangled musically as he searched for the right one; he inserted it, twisted it round, and drew open the heavy door. A dazzle of sunlight poured out of the room, blinding me, and with it came a deafening chorus of bird song; it was as though Kralesky had opened the gates of Paradise in the grubby corridor at the top of his house. The attic was vast, stretching away across almost the whole top of the house. It was uncarpeted, and the only piece of furniture was a large wooden table in the centre of the room. But the walls were linked, from floor to ceiling with row upon row of big, airy cages containing dozens of fluttering, chirruping birds. The floor of the room was covered with a fine layer of bird seed, so that as you walked your feet scrunched pleasantly, as though you were on a shingle beach. Fascinated by this mass of birds I edged slowly round the room, pausing to gaze into each cage, while Kralesky (who appeared to have forgotten my existence) seized a large watering-can from the table and danced nimbly from cage to cage, filling water-pots.

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1 hour 45 minutes

Additional Materials: Reading Booklet Insert

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

For Examiner's Use	
1(a)	
1(b)	
1(c)	
1(d)	
1(e)	
1(f)	
1(g)	
1(h)(i)	
1(h)(ii)	
1(h)(iii)	
1(i)	
2	
Total	

This document consists of **6** printed pages, **2** blank pages and **1** Insert.

Question 1

Read carefully the passage *My Tutor Kralefsky* in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer all the questions.

- (a) Kralefsky lives in an apartment in a large house. Give **two** details from paragraph one (Kralefsky lived ...) about the outside of this house.

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• [2]

- (b) Give **two** details from paragraph one (Kralefsky lived ...) which show that Gerry was not over keen on visiting his new tutor.

•
• [2]

- (c) Which phrase in lines 13–14 tells you that Kralefsky is both good-natured and correct in his behaviour?

..... [1]

- (d) Re-read paragraph two (I decided ...). Choose **three** phrases used by the writer which describe Kralefsky's strange appearance and character.

Explain how each of these phrases helps to convey this sense of eccentricity.

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

.....

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

.....

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

..... [6]

- (e) Explain, **using your own words**, Gerry's reaction to Kralefsky's comment about how they must become friends (line 24).

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.....

..... [2]

- (f) Give **two** reasons why Kralefsky decided to take Gerry to see his birds before they started the lesson.

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• [2]

- (g) Explain the writer's deliberate contrast in the phrase 'gates of Paradise in the grubby corridor' (line 40).

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..... [2]

- (h) Explain, **using your own words**, what the writer means by

- (i) 'exclaimed rapturously' (line 22)

.....

..... [2]

- (ii) 'volunteered modestly' (line 33)

.....

..... [2]

- (iii) 'danced nimbly' (line 48)

.....

..... [2]

- Write a paragraph of about 50–70 words.

.....[7

[Total: 30]

Imagine you are Gerry. When you get home you tell your older brother about your lesson with Kralefsky. You should tell your brother:

- Write the account of the conversation between Gerry and his brother.**

You should base your ideas on what you have read in the passage, but do not copy from it.

You should write between 1 and 1½ sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a full page of a worksheet designed for handwriting practice. It features 15 evenly spaced, horizontal dashed lines across the entire width of the page. The background is plain white, providing a clear guide for letter height and placement. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.

